

Create Your Own Music with Free Software

The production of music brings out some of the deepest levels of creativity in people. Each of us can explore our musical talents with the help of open source software. This article is a comprehensive guide to creating music with free software.



When a symphony created by a large-scale orchestra gets compressed into bits and bytes, can the free software world stand by, idle? Definitely not! Thanks to creative developers and energetic communities, we now have a set of applications to perform the entire music production workflow that can support even professional studios.

Let's get acquainted with some of these packages and learn how to set up a home studio using free software.

Installation

You have two options to make your PC a music studio with GNU/Linux. The first one is to install the necessary packages on the distro you are using now. The second one is to install a distro that focuses on multimedia production. If you don't take music production seriously, just go with the first choice. Otherwise, you can try the live CD of a

multimedia distro, and install it alongside or by replacing the current operating system.

Let us first explore some of the necessary packages and learn how to install and use them.

Hydrogen: Starting with the drums!

If you are new to music production, it would be a good idea to start with the drums. This is because you can create interesting percussion patterns without knowing anything about music theory and the twelve notes. You'll perhaps be familiar with some smartphone drum machines also. Starting with such apps will get you quick outputs, which will make you confident. Later, you can move on to score writers and learn music theory, gradually.

I have chosen Hydrogen as our digital drum machine. It is really rich, but never compromises on simplicity. You can install Hydrogen by giving the following command (in